



Shelby the Sea Turtle Bag Charm

A pocket sea turtle on a keyring — the classic market impulse buy; under half an hour, a couple of grams of yarn, and the head and flippers are worked straight into the shell so there is almost nothing to sew

Design Code NS 09

30 minutes

Easy

~3 g of yarn

Stitch counts verified

About 3.7 cm (1.5 in) across the flippers, 3.2 cm long and 1.9 cm deep • DK cotton on a 2.5 mm hook • shell and underside both finish at 24 stitches • bigger 5.7 cm version included

DK cotton ~1 g shell + ~1 g body • 2.5 mm hook • two 4 mm safety eyes or French knots • one 25 mm keyring per turtle

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SAFETY — EYES & KEYRING

Two 4 mm safety eyes are small parts. At this size French knots are the better fit (see section 4). Not tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71; for children under 3 use French knots.

The keyring is the other hazard: attach it through TWO stitches at the back of the shell and knot the yarn inside — a charm that comes off a bag is a small part with a metal ring.

Materials

- **Shell yarn:** DK / light worsted (#3) cotton, about 1 g — sage, teal, mustard or rust.
- **Body yarn:** DK cotton, about 1 g in contrast cream, sand or pale green.
- **Hook & eyes:** 2.5 mm (US C-2). Two 4 mm safety eyes or two black French knots.
- **Also:** a pinch of polyfill (under 1 g), tapestry needle, one 25 mm keyring or lobster clasp per turtle.

Gauge & size check

About 3.5 mm per stitch and 3.2 mm per round.

The whole charm is 203 stitches (~3 m of DK); 24 stitches = a 26.7 mm disc that sets the size.

Abbreviations — US terms

MR magic ring • sc single crochet • hdc half double crochet • inc increase • sl st slip stitch • BLO back loop only • FLO front loops only • FO fasten off.

Construction at a glance

- **Almost no sewing.** the head and flippers are clusters worked straight into the underside's last round; only shell and underside are whip-stitched together.

The techniques that make this pattern

- **1. Magic ring & spiral** — start in a magic ring and work continuous spiral rounds with a marker — no joins, no chain 1 between rounds.
- **2. Back loop only (BLO)** — work into the far loop only; the unused loops form a raised ridge. On the shell that ridge is the rim — it makes the dome read as a shell rather than a bun.
- **3. Clusters into one stitch** — the trick of the head and flippers: work every stitch of the group into ONE stitch of the previous round so they share an anchor and fan into a bump. Each cluster consumes one stitch and produces as many as it contains — so a 24-stitch round produces 35.
- **4. Whip stitch & French knots** — join shell and underside with an even whip stitch so the seam does not pucker. Eyes: bring the needle up, wrap the floss once or twice around the needle, push back down close by and pull slowly.

1 · Shell — make 1

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	6 sc in MR	6	
2	inc in each st around	12	
3	[sc, inc] x 6	18	
4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	24	
5	BLO sc around	24	rim ridge
6	sc in each st around	24	FO, 30 cm tail

Before joining, embroider five or six shallow V shapes in a darker shade across the dome — two minutes, and the difference between a turtle and a green blob.

2 · Underside — contrast flat disc with head & flippers worked in

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	6 sc in MR	6	
2	inc in each st around	12	
3	[sc, inc] x 6	18	
4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	24	do NOT fasten off
5	3 sc, (sc,hdc,hdc,sc) in next st, 4 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 3 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 4 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 3 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 2 sc		
		35	head & flippers

Rnd 5 consumes 3+1+4+1+3+1+4+1+3+1+2 = 24 stitches (closing the disc) and produces 35. The first four-stitch bump is the HEAD; the four smaller bumps are flippers. Sl st in the next stitch and fasten off with a 20 cm tail. The bumps land on stitches 4, 9, 13, 18 and 22, placing the front flippers either side of the head.

4 • Face — read before you join

The head bump is only ~7-10 mm across, and a 4 mm safety-eye washer (6-7 mm) often will not fit inside it. Use two small black FRENCH KNOTS, 2 stitches apart, low on the head bump. If you do use safety eyes, place them 1 stitch apart and seat the washers BEFORE joining — once the shell is on you cannot reach inside.

5 • Joining & keyring

Fix the eyes first. Hold the shell to the underside, wrong sides together, head pointing away from the shell's tail. Whip-stitch with the shell's 30 cm tail, matching 24 to 24 — NOT 24 to 35: the underside's outer round has 35 stitches but only 24 anchor positions (19 plain + 5 clusters). Put one shell stitch against each anchor; at a bump, pass through the BASE stitch the bump was worked into, not the bump itself. Add a small pinch of stuffing about three-quarters of the way round (keep it flat — the shell holds only ~8 cm³). Weave in ends. Attach the keyring through TWO stitches at the back, opposite the head, and knot inside.

The BLO rim ridge and embroidered V markings turn the dome into a shell.

6 • Bigger Shelby (~5.7 cm across)

Shell: R1: 6 sc in MR (6). R2: inc x6 (12). R3: [sc, inc] x6 (18). R4: [2 sc, inc] x6 (24). R5: [3 sc, inc] x6 (30). R6: [4 sc, inc] x6 (36). R7: [5 sc, inc] x6 (42). R8: BLO sc around (42). R9: sc around (42).

Underside: R1–R7 the same to 42, do not fasten off. Rnd 8: 7 sc, (sc,hdc,hdc,sc) in next, 8 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 7 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 8 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next, 7 sc, (sc,hdc,sc) in next = 53, consuming 42 anchors. Join 42 to 42 by the same rule. Allow 45–50 minutes and ~4 g.

Finishing touches

- **Shell markings:** embroider 5–6 shallow Vs on the dome before joining.
- **Keyring:** through two back stitches, knotted inside — the strongest anchor for a bag charm.
- **Stuffing:** a pinch only; the charm should stay flat against a bag.

For your Etsy listing

- **Sell as:** bag charm / keyring — a market-stall impulse buy at a pocket price.
- **Care:** spot clean; cotton DK is machine washable in a mesh bag, but the keyring hardware prefers hand washing.

Colorways

 Sage  Teal  Mustard  Rust

Troubleshooting

- **Flippers uneven.** count the plain runs between bumps: 3, 4, 3, 4, 3, then 2 at the end.
- **Keyring pulls out / too fat to hang.** attach through two stitches and knot inside. Use less stuffing so the charm stays flat against a bag.
- **Shell and base won't pair.** count anchor positions (19 plain + 5 bumps = 24), not the 35 outer stitches.

Why this pattern works — validation summary

Every stitch count in this pattern was checked with deterministic math (Crochet Pattern Checker): round-by-round production vs. consumption, stated counts, and every size claim against the stated gauge.

Check	Result
Shell 6 → 24 with BLO rim; underside disc 6 → 24	✓ verified
Cluster round: consumes 3+1+4+1+3+1+4+1+3+1+2 = 24 → produces 35	✓ verified
Bump positions land on stitches 4, 9, 13, 18, 22	✓ verified
Joining 24-to-24: 19 plain + 5 cluster anchors = 24	✓ verified
Whole charm = 108 + 95 = 203 stitches (~3 m of DK)	✓ verified
24 sts x 3.5 mm = 26.7 mm disc; big disc 42 sts = 46.8 mm ~ 5.7 cm with bumps	✓ verified
Big cluster round: consumes 42 → produces 53	✓ verified

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SAFETY REMINDER

Shelby uses 4 mm safety eyes (French knots recommended at this size) and a metal keyring. Sold as a keyring/bag charm; not tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71. For children under 3 use French knots, attach the ring through two stitches and knot inside.

Happy crocheting! Tag your makes with #NovalityStore and #ShelbyTheSeaTurtle — thank you for supporting an independent pattern designer.